most powerful muscle of the whole body. It is protected from friction against other organs by a smooth serous membrane or sac containing cardiacal fluid, and this sac is spread over the whole surface of the heart, and so doubled on itself as to form a close bag, called the perieardium, or heart-case.

The heart itself is divided internally in the direction of its length into two halves, which, though so closely conneeted as to form one, constitute it in reality a double organ. Eaeh part being called upon to perform different functions from the other, the walls of eaeh side differ in thickness in proportion to their uses. Thus, the right side (the office of which is simply to receive the blood and propel it with moderate force into the lungs) exhibits muscular walls less thick, and valves less elaborately fashioned, than the left, through which the blood is received from the lungs, and propelled by the aortal artery through the whole body.

There are four principal cavities in the heart, the first two of which are termed auricles, one situated on eaeh side, right and left, though not exactly uniform; and two other cavities termed ventricles, similarly located, though less uniform even than the auricles. The auricles perform the part of receivers, the ventrieles that of propellers.

Between each eavity there is a beautifully constructed valve, the duty of which is to permit the flow of blood in one direction, but to prevent its return again through the same orifice.

The auricle on the right side is furnished with a three-pointed valve, called tricuspid, and that on the